PROGRESS REPORT

Botswana: progress report, October 2025 – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the repository tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the repository holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this repository, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-10-01 to 2026-10-12.

Progress values. *Movement* — some form of progress, however minor, has been recorded. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the repository holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the repository holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Movement, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	**Digital transformation strategy**	An ICT roadmap to 2030 targets 100,000 ICT jobs within five years and a double-digit sector share of output; its priorities appear as projects in no estimates volume. 2026-03-09 — a roadmap to 2030 was set out at a policy dialogue, targeting 100,000 ICT jobs within five years and a double-digit ICT share of national output, following ministerial priorities stated in November 2025. The repository does not establish when it was adopted, the document is not held, and its named priorities appear as projects in no estimates volume. The institution meant to carry it has not arrived. A Digital Services Authority was announced in the ministry's plan for the year with no establishing instrument found, and it was publicly contested as duplicative a year earlier. Nothing is on record being built. An e-waste strategy is the one instrument that did land: launched in July 2026 with an inter-agency memorandum, and no targets, budget, collection volumes or implementation dates published. 2026-09-23 - the President said the SmartBots strategy would be formally launched in November 2026, with no budget or targets published. The strategy is older than its launch date suggests: Cabinet adopted it in February 2020 and implementation began that October, and a 2022 diagnostic found it to be an action plan on a website with no published text.	MOVEMENT a blueprint with no budget trail behind it
Strategies, plans and policies	**ICT strategy**	The 2007 Maitlamo policy remains the only adopted national ICT policy; the 2030 roadmap that has replaced it in ministerial usage carries no adoption date. 2025-08-17 — Parliament passed the Digital Services Bill and the Cybersecurity Bill under certificate of urgency, the legislative core of the current agenda. 2026-02-09 — the national digital-ID programme is named among the strategic projects the 2026/27 budget analyses under the economic transformation plan. The repository holds no revision of the 2007 policy and no instrument adopting the roadmap.	NO CHANGE the adopted policy is nineteen years old
Strategies, plans and policies	**Broadband strategy**	The 2018 National Broadband Strategy is unrevised, but its funding and its service-quality machinery both moved this year. 2025-09-01 — a framework formalised the levy funding the strategy's universal-access arm and set the fund's governance and categories of intervention. 2026-04-01 — service-quality guidelines came into force for licensed communications operators, the first enforceable nationwide quality regime the repository holds. The strategy itself has not been revised since June 2018 and no successor is on the record.	MOVEMENT on the machinery around the strategy rather than the strategy
Strategies, plans and policies	**Data storage / cloud strategy**	No national data-storage or cloud strategy is held; the Tier III Digital Delta data centre is the nearest thing to one. 2025-11-25 — the Digital Delta Data Centre was launched as a Tier III certified facility, with core government systems to migrate onto it. 2025-10-17 — the Digital Services Act supplies the hosting and information-security architecture around the build. The repository holds no standalone cloud or data-storage strategy, and no policy stating where government workloads must sit.	MOVEMENT facilities with no strategy behind them

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	**Data interoperability framework / roadmap**	The Digital Services Act requires a framework for secure exchange of information and an information gateway; neither the framework nor a roadmap is published. 2025-10-17 — sections 12 and 22 require a standardised framework for secure exchange of information and an information gateway. 2026-02-17 — a programme running since August 2024 is improving and aligning the national interoperability framework, its standards, guidelines and tools. No framework document, roadmap or timetable has been published, and the repository carries nothing on the gateway being built.	MOVEMENT a statutory duty with no published framework
Strategies, plans and policies	**AI strategy**	The National AI Policy was reported at an advanced stage in December 2025 and is not adopted. 2025-08-13 — an assistant minister said the policy was being finalised, naming pilots in agriculture, remote-area health diagnostics and the digitisation of licensing and social welfare. 2025-12-22 — the country profile still records the policy at an advanced stage, four months later. The readiness assessment behind it was completed and published. No draft text, adoption date or implementation plan is held.	MOVEMENT at final drafting for a second year
Strategies, plans and policies	**Data localisation policies**	The minister stated an intention to compel businesses to store data in Botswana; no bill, draft or date is on file. 2025-11-25 — at the launch of the national data centre the minister announced an intention to amend the Data Protection Act to compel businesses to store data in Botswana. No bill, draft or date has followed in the nine months since, and nothing of the kind was proposed before. The Act as in force already permits transfer subject to approved-country limits and an in-country copy, so the announced amendment would replace a conditional regime with a compulsory one. The capacity to absorb it now exists: a certified national data centre and a private facility are reported under data storage, and government migration into the first is under way. What is missing is the instrument.	MOVEMENT
Strategies, plans and policies	**Data governance policy**	No standalone data-governance policy is held; the Digital Services Act carries the enterprise data inventory and information-resource duties instead. 2025-10-17 — the Act establishes the Digital Services Authority and requires enterprise data inventories, information resource management and information-security provision. 2026-02-02 — the public service began harmonising employee privacy notices and issued a standard data-subject-rights form. The repository holds no data-governance policy document, and no statement of who owns government data across ministries.	MOVEMENT statute and practice moving with no policy between them
Strategies, plans and policies	**Open data policy**	Part V of the Digital Services Act mandates a national open data policy; the policy itself is not published. 2025-10-17 — section 24 requires a national open data policy and machine-readable publication. 2026-03-14 — terms of reference were issued for a second phase of open data hackathons and a forum, tied to the policy's anticipated adoption by Parliament. The statutory duty was made in October 2025 and no draft policy, adoption date or national portal has followed.	MOVEMENT mandated by statute and still unadopted

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	**Data protection legislation**	The 2024 Data Protection Act has been in force since January 2025, repealing the 2018 Act; what moved in the window is enforcement. The Act came into force on 14 January 2025, repealing the 2018 statute. It did not change in the window. What changed is that it began to bite. The commission that had three contract officers, no premises, no published address and no website in July 2025 issued a determination and enforcement notice against a government directorate in July 2026, reported under the authority below. The one amendment in prospect is the localisation duty reported under policy, which has no draft. No implementing regulations, codes of practice or approved-country list appear on this ledger. 2021-10-15 - the commencement instrument is now held in full: Statutory Instrument 86 of 2021 brought the Data Protection Act No. 32 of 2018 into operation on publication on 15 October 2021. It dates the regime the repository had been carrying from its 2024 re-enactment.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	**Cybersecurity legislation**	The Cybersecurity Act was assented in November 2025 and gazetted, and was still not in force at the window's close, its stated April 2026 commencement having passed. 2025-11-05 — the Act was assented and gazetted on 11 November 2025, with commencement on notice, against a Bill only at the start of the window. Commencement was stated for April 2026 and that date passed with no notice on file. Section 3(2) excludes classified information held by eight security and revenue bodies. So the 2018 cybercrime statute remains the operative law, its repeal enacted and not commenced. The authority the Act creates is in the same position. It exists in law with a board, a chief executive, a licensing power over cybersecurity providers, a power to approve software before market placement and a critical-infrastructure mandate, and it is not established, with no organisation or vote in the year's estimates — an authority in law with no money at both the legal and the fiscal end.	MOVEMENT made and gazetted but not in force
Legislation and regulation	**Legislation covering digital id**	Section 14 of the Digital Services Act provides for online unique identification, and the amending registration Act commenced in November 2025. 2025-10-17 — the Digital Services Act was assented, its section 14 providing for online unique identification. 2026-02-24 — the ministry confirmed the National Registration (Amendment) Act No. 7 of 2025 commenced in November 2025, and reported a digital-ID roadmap facilitated by the African Development Bank due at the end of March 2026. No commencement notice for the Digital Services Act itself is held, and no roadmap document.	MOVEMENT
Legislation and regulation	**Digital payments legislation**	Electronic payment regulations were amended in April 2026, extending scope to value transfer services and reaching beneficial owners, with unlicensed operation punishable by P1,000,000 and five years. 2026-04-02 — amended regulations came into effect extending scope to money or value transfer services, taking fit-and-proper tests down to beneficial owners and 10% shareholders, and making unlicensed operation punishable by P1,000,000 and five years, with the central bank's implementation release in July. Float interest is ring-fenced and directed by the central bank, and financial-inclusion promotion was dropped from the permitted uses without being replaced by any customer entitlement — which is the change a wallet holder would notice if anyone told them. The virtual-asset regime is unchanged and still criticised: the Act is in force with crypto not legal tender, and a regional follow-up assessment in February 2026 still records provider-oversight shortcomings.	MOVEMENT

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Legislation and regulation	**Legislation enabling data interoperability**	The Digital Services Act supplies the enabling law for data interoperability, at sections 12 and 22. 2025-10-17 — the Act requires a standardised framework for secure exchange of information and an information gateway, the first statutory basis for cross-government data exchange the repository holds. No regulations have been made under either section, and the repository carries nothing on the gateway being built. 2026-09-14 — the data policy is being turned into a strategy: a five-day capacity-building and stakeholder workshop was held to make its principles implementable. No draft or adoption date is published.	MOVEMENT
Legislation and regulation	**AI legislation / regulations**	No AI-specific Act or regulation exists; the Data Protection Act 2024 is the closest adjacent enacted instrument. 2025-12-22 — the country profile records no AI legislation and the national policy at an advanced stage. 2025-08-13 — a minister said the policy was in final drafting, the earliest in-window movement toward one. The absence was searched on 31 August 2026 and nothing was found: no Bill, no regulations under an existing statute, and no announced timetable for either.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	**E-commerce legislation**	The Electronic Communications and Transactions Act 2014 is the principal e-commerce statute; the movement this year was in taxing digital supply. 2014-05-14 — the Act gives legal recognition to electronic communications and transactions and is unamended on the record. 2026-05-29 — regulations set the registration and compliance machinery for foreign suppliers of remote services. 2026-07-01 — the Value Added Tax Act 2026 was gazetted, taxing remote services and electronic marketplaces supplied into Botswana. The capture of the 2014 Act is a truncated scan and does not carry its commencement date.	MOVEMENT on the tax side
Legislation and regulation	**Statistics legislation**	The Statistics Act commenced in December 2010 and is unamended; a second development strategy launched in its place. 2010-12-01 — the Act establishes Statistics Botswana and the national statistical system, including the ten-yearly census mandate. 2025-11-24 — the second strategy for the development of statistics was launched, after more than a year's preparation. No amendment to the Act is on the record and none is announced.	NO CHANGE with the movement in strategy rather than law
Legislation and regulation	**Access to information legislation**	The Access to Information Act was passed, its passage confirmed from the podium in November 2025; no commencement notice is held. 2024-07-26 — the Act sets out the commission's functions, its audit power and the identity-card regime, with commencement on notice. 2025-11-11 — the President confirmed passage in the State of the Nation Address. 2025-10-17 — the Digital Services Act subordinates itself to this Act and ties enterprise data inventories to its disclosure obligations. No commencement notice is on the record.	MOVEMENT passed and not commenced

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Data protection	**Data protection authority**	The commission suspended a government payslip portal by enforcement notice in July 2026, a year after operating with three contract officers and no premises. The starting position was an authority that barely existed: three contract officers, no premises, no published address, no website and no deputy commissioner in July 2025. 2026-02-11 — it began enforcing against non-bank financial institutions, and 2026-07-17 — it issued a determination and enforcement notice against the public service management directorate, suspending the government payslip portal with compliance evidence due within a month. The directorate published a privacy notice on 6 July, completed an impact assessment on 13 July and added multi-factor authentication and a disaster-recovery plan, with no reopening date. The determination itself is not held; both accounts are press carries. It is the first published enforcement against a government body on this ledger, and the regulator still has no budget organisation or line of its own.	MOVEMENT
Data protection	**National data protection readiness**	The Data Protection Act 2024 is in force and the commission is taking and investigating complaints. 2024-10-29 — the Act was gazetted, repealing the 2018 statute and continuing the Information and Data Protection Commission. 2026-02-02 — the commissioner confirmed the commission is receiving and empowered to investigate complaints of unlawful processing, as the public service began harmonising employee privacy notices and issued a standard data-subject-rights form. No figure for complaints received, staffing or budget is published. 2025-12 — no retention regulations had been made under the Act, which leaves retention schedules to them, although the commission can fine up to P1 million for keeping data too long.	MOVEMENT
Regional collaboration	**Regional policy collaboration**	Two bilateral memoranda were signed in a fortnight — one with Namibia on transformation, cybersecurity, connectivity and skills — with no value or deliverable published for either. 2026-08-07 — the two countries' ICT ministries signed at Kasane with their operators and regulators, covering digital transformation, cybersecurity, connectivity and skills development, with the accompanying disclosure costing the remaining corridor coverage gaps at about N$52 million across 13 new sites and recording the two national response teams deepening cooperation, announced two days before and confirmed on the day. No term, funding or data-governance provision is published and the signed instrument is not held. 2026-08-19 — the two countries' innovation agencies signed on cross-border innovation and technology commercialisation, framed by both as advancing the region's industrialisation agenda. No value, workstream, deliverable or duration is published. Two memoranda in a fortnight, neither costed, is the shape of this section: the delivered regional work is the roaming agreement and the fibre interconnection reported elsewhere.	MOVEMENT
Regional collaboration	**Regional legal harmonisation**	Botswana signed the SADC Regional Development Fund operationalisation agreement in March 2026, the clearest regional legal step in the window. 2000-08-07 — the SADC Protocol on Legal Affairs constitutes the regional legal sector Botswana harmonises through. 2026-03-31 — Botswana signed the agreement operationalising the regional development fund, together with the agreement amending the protocol on finance and investment. 2026-08-17 — the 46th summit approved the agreement establishing a regional tourism univisa. No domestication instrument for any of the three is held.	MOVEMENT

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Regional collaboration	**Shared regional infrastructure**	Regional roaming was extended to six states with cuts of between 10% and 98.6%, and a bid to host the regional internet exchange reached the final two. 2026-03-13 — the One Network Area was extended to five further states, making six, with roaming cuts of between 10% and 98.6%, data roaming to one neighbour down by up to 94% and incoming messages free across participants, against reduced rates with a single neighbour before. Engagement with one further state is stated as ongoing. 2025-11-27 — a bid to host the regional internet exchange was shortlisted to the final two, and no award decision is on record in the eight months since. Roaming is the one regional instrument in this report that reaches a citizen's bill directly, and it is also the one with a published effect.	MOVEMENT
Regional collaboration	**Cross-border data transfers**	Botswana is one of sixteen states in a regional cross-border identity and know-your-customer framework, with no national integration step, pilot or date held. 2025-08-26 — a regional cross-border digital public infrastructure and federated know-your-customer framework was set out by the regional central bank committee, naming Botswana among sixteen participating states. No Botswana-specific integration step, pilot or date is held, and the only prior real-time cross-border verification pilot named involves two other countries. 2026-06-15 — separately, existing agricultural systems are being assessed for integration into a regional agricultural information system at a four-day national readiness workshop, with no integration date or committed systems held. Both are readiness exercises. The domestic layer they would connect to is thin: there is no certificate-backed identity verification, reported under authentication, and no national data exchange appears anywhere on this ledger.	MOVEMENT
Standards	**National interoperability standards**	The national interoperability framework is being aligned under an externally funded programme; the framework itself is not published. 2025-10-17 — the Digital Services Act requires a standardised framework for secure exchange of information, an information gateway and an interoperability standard. 2026-02-17 — a programme running since August 2024 through Expertise France, ESTDEV and HAUS is improving and aligning the framework, its standards, guidelines and tools. No standard, framework document or conformance regime is published, and no list of the systems the framework covers.	MOVEMENT under external assistance
Standards	**National quality standards**	The standards bureau publishes an annual standards-development programme, under a statute in force since 1995. 1995 — the Standards Act establishes the Botswana Bureau of Standards and the Standards Council. 2026-04-16 — issue 341 of the annual standardisation work programme was published, setting the pipeline of standards-development projects. 2025-11-21 — a national quality standard for school uniforms was developed and published, on the minister's account to Parliament. No ICT or data standard from the programme is separately identified in the repository.	MOVEMENT

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Standards	**Adoption of international standards**	A candidature for the international radio regulations board is being promoted with member-state lobbying; the election has not been held. 2026-05 — a candidature for the international radio regulations board was promoted at a regional preparatory meeting, with member-state lobbying under way for the 2027-2030 term. The election has not been held and no baseline was held before this. It is the only standards-body engagement on this ledger. Domestically the picture is the opposite: no national address-protocol transition plan, target date or measured adoption figure exists, only a regulator training workshop, so a country seeking a seat on an international standards board has no published standards programme of its own.	MOVEMENT
Public debate and participation in policymaking	**Non-governmental contribution to national policy**	The National Planning Act provides the formal channel, while civil society rejected the constitution amendment process outright. 2024-01-30 — the Act establishes the National Planning Commission, a duty to liaise with civil society and a power to form thematic working groups. 2025-08-20 — the civil-society umbrella body mobilised against and formally rejected the Constitution (Amendment) Bill No. 14 of 2025, demanding a people-driven Constitutional Review Act. 2026-02-10 — the same body pressed government directly for structured and inclusive participation on the proposed Constitutional Court, six months after the rejection. The repository holds no record of a thematic working group being convened under the Act.	MIXED a statutory channel alongside a contested one
Public debate and participation in policymaking	**Open discussion of government policy**	Botswana Speaks became a Parliamentary Services Division in April 2025 and released a mobile application on both app stores. 2025-04 — the citizen-to-Parliament platform transitioned into a Parliamentary Services Division, was upgraded, and a mobile application was released on both app stores; it is free and reachable by web and phone. 2026-04-13 — a public panel in Tlokweng on the proposed Constitutional Court drew legal experts, traditional leadership, political representatives and the public. 2025-10-13 — the health ministry opened the proposed national health insurance scheme to private providers and medical-aid societies at a stakeholder session. No usage figure for the platform is published.	MOVEMENT

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	**Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation**	Three digital capital lines were cut for the new year after outturns of 38.7%, 9.0% and nil; one small line rose and was fully spent. The pattern is appropriation followed by non-execution followed by a cut. The communications ministry ICT project falls to P251,000,000 after P369,079,545 appropriated and P142,712,599 spent, 38.7%, a third consecutive cut from P736.6m two years earlier. The research and development project falls to P213,700,000 after a 9.0% outturn; its scope spans satellite, nuclear and biotechnology as well as digital. Basic education computerisation falls to P253,000,000 after P270,000,000 was appropriated, revised to P38,819,833 and nothing at all was spent — the vote behind the largest learning-technology award in this report. Two lines hold. Higher education computerisation rises to P16,000,000 after a full spend of P3,950,000, the only clean-scope digital line with a 100% outturn, and the shared digital services recurrent vote is broadly flat at P587,310,850, the largest single recurrent line. Outside the estimates entirely, P4.13bn was sought for revenue-service modernisation under the twelfth development plan, inside a P8.8bn digital ask, with no appropriation trail because the revenue service appears in no budget organisation. No audited outturn exists for any digital line in any year.	REGRESSED
Financial sustainability	**Financial sustainability of digital systems**		NO EVIDENCE
MoUs and other agreements	**Strategic relationships**	An operator and the special economic zones authority signed a framework for connected utilities, smart security, digital platforms and connectivity, with no value stated. 2026-03-17 — a memorandum between a mobile operator and the special economic zones authority set a framework for connected utilities, smart security, digital platforms and connectivity inside the zones. No value is stated and the exact signature date is not published. It is the only operator-to-state framework on this ledger, and it is the one instrument here that ties connectivity to an industrial-policy vehicle rather than to a coverage target. No project, site or investment under it has been reported in the five months since.	MOVEMENT
New investments	**Mobilisation of non-state finance**	A technology fund reached a GBP 5m first close against a GBP 50m target, and ten startups entered a twelve-month programme routed to a US$150m fund. 2026-04-21 — a technology fund launched with a GBP 50m target, GBP 10m committed and a GBP 5m first close, writing tickets of GBP 25,000 to 100,000 for its accelerator and GBP 0.5m to 2m for growth, reported at first close. The GBP 50m is a target rather than capital raised, and a dollar headline circulating elsewhere converts the target rather than the raise. 2026-03-10 — a twelve-month programme for ten climate and digital startups launched, routed to a US$150m decarbonisation fund, with the launch reported the following week. No Botswana-specific allocation from that fund is stated. Both are new and both are foreign-managed. No domestic venture capital, angel network or exit appears anywhere on this ledger.	MOVEMENT

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New investments	**Development-partner project financing**	Three development-partner packages moved in the window, the largest a EUR110m facility to the Botswana Development Corporation. 2026-01-26 — the World Bank board approved a $43m health emergency preparedness project, a $40m loan and a $3m grant, whose digital component is a logistics management system for medical supplies. 2026-02-17 — the renewable energy support and access project became effective on 3 December 2025 and first disbursed on 23 December, an $88m IBRD loan with Green Climate Fund co-financing. 2026-07-15 — a EUR110m mixed credit facility to the Botswana Development Corporation and a EUR500,000 grant to the agriculture university were signed in Gaborone. The 2026/27 budget places development-partner and private financing at the centre of the transformation plan's delivery.	MOVEMENT

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	**Mobile penetration**	Mobile telephony subscriptions reached 4,370,350 by September 2025, a rise of 6%%, and the state-held operator targets commercial 5G in Gaborone by October 2026, four years behind the other two. 2026-03-01 — the regulator reported 4,370,350 mobile telephony subscriptions at September 2025 against 4,104,304 a year earlier, and 3,112,962 mobile broadband subscriptions against 2,915,158. Prepaid accounts were 96% of the mobile base and mobile money subscriptions rose 24% to 1,455,986. 2025-09-22 — all three mobile operators cut retail tariffs after the regulator's costing and pricing study, with inter-network termination rates reduced. The report publishes subscription counts and no penetration rate, so the share of people connected cannot be stated from the repository. 2026-08-31 — the state-held operator commits more than P240 million for 2026/27 and targets commercial 5G in Gaborone by October, having spent P225.5 million in 2025/26 upgrading 151 sites to 4G, and putting population coverage at 97 per cent for 2G and 4G and 62 per cent for 3G. The other two operators have been live on 5G since 2022. The same census puts 4G coverage at approximately 98% of the population and names infrastructure as the country's strongest competitive advantage. It is a figure carried in a sector report rather than a regulator's return, and coverage is not use.	MOVEMENT

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Connectivity	**Internet usage**	Penetration is put at 81.4% on 2.09m users at end-2025, against a regulator figure of about 73% three weeks earlier, and the two are unreconciled. 2025-11-26 — an end-2025 estimate puts internet users at 2.09m and penetration at 81.4%. It is a reference-study figure, and the regulator is separately reported at about 73% three weeks earlier, with the repository reconciling neither against the other. No official penetration figure is held for the country at any date — only a venture fund's promotional claim and a reference study — so the eight-point spread cannot be settled. The absence is dated rather than assumed: the regulator's own state-of-ICT publication carries no penetration rate, searched again on 31 August 2026. That matters here because the roadmap reported under strategy rests on an ICT share of output and a jobs target, and the denominator for both is a population whose connection rate the state does not publish. The household series is firmer than either national figure. Household internet access reached 68.9 per cent in 2024, up 28.3 percentage points on 2014, with 31.1 per cent of households having none against 59.4 per cent a decade earlier. Among those without, the commonest reasons were equipment cost at 34.3 per cent and lack of skills at 32.4 - so what is missing is devices and skills rather than coverage.	MIXED household access far ahead of the reasons households give for going without
Connectivity	**Mobile affordability**	The incumbent's prepaid data tariffs were cut with regulator approval on a pricing study, and a device-financing facility has published no uptake in fifteen months. 2026-02-18 — the regulator approved revised prepaid tariffs with immediate effect on a May 2025 pricing study: 1.5GB a day for P10, 4GB a month for P65, 30GB over 30 days for P199 and 100GB over 30 days for P349. The other two operators revised earlier under the same study and their schedules are not held, so the market-wide effect cannot be stated. The device side has not moved. The country's first mobile device financing facility launched in May 2025 and has published no uptake, portfolio or default figure in the fifteen months since. A regulator-driven price cut with a published schedule is unusual in this report; what is missing is any measure of what it changed.	MOVEMENT
Connectivity	**National fibre backbone**	About 16,000 km of fibre is stated laid, linking four neighbours, and a P43m local-access project connected three villages and 191 customers. 2026-03-09 — the minister put the network at about 16,000 km of fibre laid, linking South Africa, Namibia, Zimbabwe and Zambia, a statement with no published register behind it. 2026-08-16 — a P43m local-access programme completed, extending fibre to three villages and connecting 191 customers with 210 construction jobs created, by an operator reporting P376m revenue and 99.7% availability across the backbone, confirmed in a third account. Against those figures, a Village Connectivity Project is stated as running with no site count, target, budget or completion date published: the state names the programme and publishes no figure against it, while the wholesale operator publishes down to the customer.	MOVEMENT

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Connectivity	**International internet bandwidth**	The state wholesaler raised available international capacity through South Africa from 300 Gbit/s to 1 Tbit/s under a long-term lease, and a first direct fibre link with Namibia was completed. 2026-09-23 - the state wholesaler signed a long-term lease with an unnamed South African partner, raising available international capacity through the Ramatlabama and Pioneer Gate crossings from 300 Gbit/s to 1 Tbit/s, on its own figures. 2026-08-10 — the Namibian operator completed the Gobabis-Buitepos link, now interconnecting at Charles Hill, which the two sides describe as the first direct cross-border fibre link between them, against a memorandum only in February 2026. No capacity, commissioning date or traffic figure is published for the link and the corridor beyond it is not reported delivered. 2026-07-06 — a second corridor's first phase is live at 800Gbps on equipment rated over 10Tbps, with phase two due September 2026; it is described as a three-country corridor and the live section is inside a neighbour, with no Botswana segment dated. Measurement has not moved with the build. International traffic was just over 100Gbps in February 2025, up from under 8Gbps in 2015, after a P100m gateway upgrade, and no later figure has been published — the only national traffic figure the repository holds, eighteen months old at the window's close.	MOVEMENT
Connectivity	**Internet Exchange Points**	Digital Delta IX is registered and operating in Gaborone with one peer and 10G of capacity, while the 2005 association exchange is recorded defunct. 2026-04-21 — the exchange's registry entry records one peer, one connection and 10G of total capacity, the only public description of its size. 2025-11-25 — the Tier III data centre behind the exchange was launched. 2026-02-18 — Namibia's MTC and BoFiNet agreed cross-border interconnection, IP transit and wholesale capacity exchange through the Buitepos-Ngoma corridor. No traffic figure for the exchange is published. The first exchange is gone. The association-run exchange established in Gaborone in October 2005 is recorded as defunct in the international directory, with no subnets, facilities, contacts or switches listed and only a comment that work is happening and formalities remain to be sorted out. Nothing in the repository records when it stopped operating or why, so a country that has had an exchange point for twenty years is starting again with one peer. 2026-10-06 - the state fibre operator announced the launch of its internet exchange point for local traffic; no member count is given.	MIXED a new exchange with one peer while the country's first is recorded defunct
Connectivity	**Satellite broadband licensing and availability**	The incumbent connected 61 rural villages by satellite with 105 areas in progress, and no update has been published since November 2025. 2025-11-28 — the incumbent operator reported 61 rural villages connected by satellite — schools, clinics and community centres — with 105 further areas in process, announced with half-year results. No baseline preceded it and no update has followed in nine months. That is the whole of the satellite record for the country: no licensing decision, no low-earth-orbit operator, no tariff and no subscriber figure appears. The one place a satellite operator does appear is in a risk register — the state wholesale operator escalated low-earth-orbit competition to its board as a structural disruption, reported under national production capacity.	MOVEMENT on one programme with nothing reported since

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Storage	**Local data centre capacity (all providers)**	A gas-powered private data centre completed its first full quarter of continuous operation, and a solar campus aimed at hyperscale compute remains a memorandum. 2026-08-03 — a private data centre reached its first full quarter of continuous operation for the quarter ended 30 June 2026, fully commissioned, with revenue the company describes as modest and at proof-of-concept scale, designed for up to 1MW with expansion subject to funding, against a first module under commissioning with generators en route and no revenue in September 2025. 2025-10-02 — a solar-powered campus targeted at hyperscale and artificial-intelligence compute is at memorandum stage inside a planned energy hub and industrial park, reported as a Dutch and American venture, with no capacity, cost, site approval or timeline and nothing on file since. 2023-12 - a mobile operator opened a US$5.2m Tier III facility at the state innovation hub in Gaborone, publishing no specifications; nothing later is held on it. 2026-10-05 - the gas supplier's annual report said the centre ran materially below its design capacity in the year to June 2026 for lack of gas.	MOVEMENT
Data Storage	**Local data centre capacity (national providers)**	The state data centre is in operation, Tier III certified and carrier-neutral, with critical government services migrated and the mid-2026 phase unconfirmed. 2025-11-25 — the state-owned data centre launched after Tier III certification in October 2025, carrier-neutral, offering storage, hosting and exchange, against a facility built but neither certified nor launched at the window's opening. 2026-05-06 — critical government services have been migrated, with the initial phase targeted for mid-2026 and no confirmation on file that it completed, against a stated intention to migrate services held at the shared digital services department. A second data centre is stated as planned with nothing further on file. The facility is the physical precondition for the localisation duty announced under policy, and the migration is the test of it — reported, so far, only in the words "critical services". Two older state facilities sit beside it: the state operator's Sentlhaga site, billed in 2020 as the country's first Uptime-certified facility, at Tier II with 120 square metres of floor, and carrier-neutral colocation at the state innovation hub, selling racks and power only. No later capacity or utilisation figure is held for either.	MOVEMENT
Data Storage	**Off-site backup capacity**	Two Tier III facilities now sell disaster recovery, the state's Digital Delta and Mascom's Innovation Centre. 2019-10 — the regulator's business continuity and disaster recovery guidelines require licensed communications operators to hold backup and recovery plans. 2025-11-25 — the government launched the Tier III Digital Delta Data Centre for hosting, recovery and backup workloads. 2026-07-13 — Mascom repositioned its Tier III centre, built for its own workloads, to sell colocation, cloud, infrastructure-as-a-service and disaster recovery externally. No capacity figure, utilisation figure or government backup policy is held.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Energy	**Sufficient energy and water for data centres**	The operating data centre runs on on-site gas supplemented by solar, and its expansion is gated on a gas gathering extension subject to funding. 2026-08-03 — on-site gas-fired generation is now supplemented by solar, with battery and compressed-gas storage under review, where renewables had been named for future phases only. Solar is specified as firming for gas, which is the reverse of the usual diesel-backup pattern. The constraint on growth is upstream. An extension of the gas gathering network to connect a further production well is stated as subject to funding, and it gates the data centre's capacity expansion, while an initial 5MW solar development has been assessed with no capital cost, approval or date. The company states these are work-programme items rather than guidance. At the other site, 250MW of solar with a foreseen 100-400MW battery system is under development on a developer statement, with no financial close, permit or grid connection on file. Data-centre growth here is gated on energy work, not on demand. 2026-09-07 - the price of that energy is under review: the power corporation's own consultation paper makes the case for a 46% tariff rise on a P9.585bn revenue requirement against a P3.477bn funding gap. It is an application rather than a determination, and no regulator decision, effective date or data-centre tariff schedule accompanies it.	MOVEMENT
Energy	**Grid reliability**	Mean time to repair fell from about 30 to 50 days to 12, and mean time between failures rose to an average of 120 days. 2026-02-13 — the power corporation reported mean time to repair down from roughly 30 to 50 days to 12, and mean time between failures averaging 120 days, while noting that units not yet remediated still take forced outages. 2026-03-04 — the 100 MWp Mmadinare solar plant reached full commercial operation in the last quarter of 2025, expected with the Morupule B work to lift the share of demand met locally. 2016 — the energy regulator carries a statutory duty to see that electricity is safe, reliable, efficient and affordable. No outage-minutes or system-average interruption figure is published.	MOVEMENT
Energy	**Rural electrification**	Electricity access stood at 76.6%% as of March 2025, with universal access targeted for 2030. 2025-10-22 — the energy compact records access at 76.6% and targets universal access by 2030, reaching an additional 220,000 households through grid extension in peri-urban and accessible rural areas and off-grid solutions further out. 2026-02-17 — Tsodilo was completed and connected to the grid in November 2025 and Chukumuchu was at tender stage, both under the 112-village programme. 2026-03-16 — off-grid solar deployment for six remote villages put access at about 83% of gazetted villages. No year-on-year national access series is held.	MOVEMENT
Technical Capacity	**Robustness of government hardware and software**	The government accounting and budgeting system was told to a parliamentary committee to be fully operational after a December 2024 upgrade, with more than 20,000 users. The committee of supply was told the software upgrade completed in December 2024 and the system is fully operational, with more than 20,000 users. No later statement, availability figure or upgrade has been held since, so the position is unchanged across the window. A further upgrade sits inside the finance ministry's development-plan allocation reported under central-bank payments governance, undated and unpriced separately. It is the only whole-of-government administrative system on this ledger with a user count attached, and the count is eighteen months old.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Technical Capacity	**Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems**	The government e-services platform was built on an open-source approach led by a local developer, against acknowledged downtime and IT-capacity gaps. 2025-10-27 — the communications minister confirmed the platform was developed through an open-source approach led by a local developer, while acknowledging perennial system downtime and IT capacity gaps. 2025-11-25 — the launch of the national Tier III data centre brought core government systems onto state-hosted infrastructure. 2026-02-10 — 52 public services are fully available online with a further 179 in integration testing. No establishment figure, vacancy rate or skills audit for government ICT staff is held.	MOVEMENT against acknowledged capacity gaps
Cybersecurity	**National cybersecurity readiness**	A four-day national cyber drill was held and a vendor security portfolio entered the market; no national strategy or authority exists. An international police assessment flagged cyber threats against both institutions and individuals in Botswana (assessment). 2026-03 — a four-day national cyber drill was held, opened by the regulator's chief executive, where none was on file at the start of the window; the repository separately records an inaugural drill in the same season. 2026-05-13 — an integrated security framework and cloud services became available to Botswana customers, on a company announcement with no customer, revenue or capacity figures. The measured position is good and thinly sourced: 0.9% of consumer transaction attempts were flagged as suspected digital fraud in 2025, the lowest of the African countries analysed, on a vendor study paywalled beyond its opening paragraph. What is missing is the institutional half. No national cybersecurity strategy document, date or version is on file, and the authority that would own one is created in law and not established, reported under legislation.	REGRESSED

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	**National data exchange system**	The statutory framework for secure exchange of information and an information gateway was enacted in October 2025; nothing on the build is held. 2025-08-17 — Parliament passed the Digital Services Bill under certificate of urgency. 2025-10-17 — sections 12 and 22 of the resulting Act require a standardised framework for secure exchange of information and an information gateway. 2025-11-25 — the Tier III data centre was launched, which the government presented as the base for its digital services. No exchange platform, technical specification, participating-agency list or timetable is on the record.	MOVEMENT enacted and not built

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	**Use of digital id in other systems**	The identity number is being reused in new systems: the labour market system integrated with it and the health exchange keys on it. 2016 — a diagnostic described reuse of the national identification system across electoral, payroll and transport systems, the fullest account the repository holds. 2026-03-05 — the health exchange's client registry, using the Omang or passport number for unique patient identification, was reported ready for deployment. 2026-03-23 — phase one of the labour market information system went operational with completed integrations to the identification system, the company registry and the government SMS gateway. No count of systems consuming the identifier is published. 2026-09 - the bankers' association launched a national eKYC project verifying bank customers against the citizen database, with no go-live date stated.	MOVEMENT
Data Exchange	**Interoperability of health systems**	The health information exchange's client and facilities registries were reported ready for deployment in March 2026. 2026-01-01 — a case study set out the national eHealth enterprise architecture and its HL7 FHIR interoperability framework, describing a health sector running numerous unconnected systems. 2026-03-05 — the ministry reported the exchange's client and facilities registries ready for deployment and phase one of the electronic medical record rolling out. No go-live date, connected-system list or data-sharing agreement is held.	MOVEMENT
Data Exchange	**Interoperability of education systems**	The credit accumulation and transfer policy took effect in November 2025, the only cross-provider education-data instrument held. 2025-11-27 — the qualifications authority's policy on credit accumulation and transfer took effect, setting the terms on which learner credit moves between education and training providers. 2026-03-23 — phase one of the labour market information system went operational with a completed education information subsystem, and a second phase funded at P8m. The repository holds nothing on a schools-level education management information system, and no technical interoperability standard between education systems.	MOVEMENT
Data Exchange	**Interoperability of social protection systems**	The Single Social Registry was operationalised and covered 98 per cent of beneficiaries in the five main programmes by March 2025. 2022 — a review described the registry's identity validation link and its proxy-means-test software, following a pilot in a handful of districts. 2025-10-07 — a completion report verified coverage of 98 per cent of beneficiaries in the five main programmes by March 2025, against a target of 75.8 per cent. 2025-11-11 — the State of the Nation Address announced the registry's operationalisation and the introduction of proxy means testing. No list of the systems the registry exchanges with is held.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	**Robustness of system**	A biometric card is itemised at P31,700,000 in the new estimates, while card replacement has been delayed since the start of 2026 on staffing and ageing equipment. The labour and home affairs ministry is contending with a cartel producing fake identity documents (report). A document cartel is a statement about the credential's integrity, not only about production capacity. 2026-04-01 — the electronic identification programme was rescoped from a public-private partnership into a broader digital identity estate integrating a national wallet and electronic government services, with a biometric identity card itemised at P31,700,000, against a partnership prioritised the year before and not progressed. Against that, the physical system is failing. A parliamentary answer attributes replacement delays running since the start of 2026 to too few production staff and ageing equipment with frequent breakdowns, with no backlog figure, no restoration date and no equipment-replacement commitment. The legislative patch is in force and not working as intended: an amendment allows a passport or driving licence to serve while a card is replaced, and service providers are reported refusing even the replacement receipt. 2017 — IDEMIA's multi-biometric platform added facial recognition to fingerprint matching.	REGRESSED
Digital Identity and CRVS	**Registration of entire population**	86.7% of people aged 15 and over held an Omang at the 2022 census, about 200,000 eligible citizens unregistered; an electronic identity card was piloted and remains at feasibility. 1986-12-24 — the National Registration Act establishes the register, its contents and the registration requirement. 2025-11-25 — a feasibility study supported by the African Development Bank and a pilot of electronic identity card production were announced in Parliament. 2022 — the population and housing census found 86.7% of people aged 15 and over holding an Omang, leaving about 200,000 of 1.5 million eligible citizens unregistered, most in the sparsely populated western districts and among San communities. No later coverage figure is held.	NO CHANGE with an electronic product still at feasibility
Digital Identity and CRVS	**National maintenance of id and credentials systems**	P108,505,050 was sought in 2026/27 for Omang card production and the registration systems' maintenance. 2026-02-24 — the ministry requested P108,505,050 to cover, among other things, the production of national identity cards and the maintenance of the birth and death registration and identification systems. No supplier, contract value or maintenance arrangement is separately published, and the repository holds no statement of where the systems are maintained or who holds the source code.	NO CHANGE funded annually and unchanged in form
Digital Identity and CRVS	**Authentication**	The public key infrastructure is funded, begun, incomplete and non-operational, with P423m secured and control transferred to the intelligence directorate. 2026-07-30 — the public accounts committee was told the project is funded, begun, incomplete and non-operational: P423m secured, control transferred to the intelligence directorate, no working system, no timeline and no accountable owner. The ministry's own headline figure appears as both P420m and P423m in the single account. The consequence is stated plainly in the same source: the country has no certificate-backed identity verification and no recognised electronic-signature layer. That is the missing floor under everything else in this report. The services portal, the payslip portal, the rescoped digital identity and the regional know-your-customer framework all assume a trust layer that P423m has not produced.	STALLED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	**Digital id from birth**	A unique number is issued at birth registration and becomes the Omang number at sixteen; no digital credential sits behind it. 2026-08-01 — the statistics office describes the birth and death registration system as partially automated and decentralised, integrated with the identification system, with the identifier issued at birth carrying through to the identity card at sixteen. 2025-11-25 — an electronic identity card was piloted and a feasibility study commissioned. No digital credential is issued at birth, and the repository holds no birth-registration completeness figure.	NO CHANGE a number from birth on paper rails
Digital Identity and CRVS	**Interoperability of birth registration and digital id**	Online registration of births, deaths and marriages is complete and waiting on the government platform to go live. 2015-09 — a country report set out the identity lifecycle from birth registration through to the identity card at sixteen, the repository's fullest technical account of the link. 2026-02-24 — the ministry reported digitisation of online birth, death and marriage registration complete, awaiting the government platform's go-live. The marriage register is still manual, and no go-live date is held.	MOVEMENT
Digital Identity and CRVS	**Use by other systems**	Identity-linked SIM registration has been mandatory for all users since March 2024, with no later regulator statement or registration rate held. Registration has been mandatory for all users since a public notice of March 2024. Nothing has moved it: no later regulator statement, registration rate or de-registration figure is held. It is the only case on this ledger of the national identity being required by another system, and it is the oldest instrument in this section. Nothing states what identity document satisfies it, which matters against the card replacement failures reported above, or how it is verified without the certificate layer the country does not have. 2023 — the Omang became usable as a travel document between Botswana and Namibia, and a German supplier was contracted in May 2023 to build a shared platform for automated card checks at the Mamuno-Trans-Kalahari crossing. Whether the automated checks are live is not stated. 2024 — the Gaborone City Council linked a city-wide facial-recognition CCTV network to the Omang database for real-time public-security surveillance, a use outside the registration statute's founding purpose.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	**Governance role of central bank**	A national payment switch is funded in plan only with no build or date, but its enabling Act has been drafted. 2025-10-31 — a national payment switch is named inside a P486m ICT allocation sought under the twelfth development plan, part of a P8.8bn digital ask. The allocation covers the switch, an accounting-system upgrade, a sandbox and electronic procurement together, and the switch carries no separate figure. No build, procurement, operator or date is on the record. So domestic interbank routing has no national infrastructure and no dated plan, while the cross-border corridor reported below is live and the payments regulations were tightened in April. The central bank's visible action in the window is regulatory rather than infrastructural. 2025-07 - the legal instrument moved ahead of the build: a National Payments Switch Act had been drafted and was going through the attorney general, the finance ministry and other state organs before it could be tabled, with the central bank unable to give a date. The switch is to carry low-cost real-time retail transactions and integrate financial technology firms through open interfaces. The central bank names its own constraints in the same account: no sovereign switch, no electronic identity for online verification, no interoperability between payment instruments and low mobile-money thresholds.	MOVEMENT the law drafted while the build stays funded in plan only
Digital Payments and Fintech	**G2P functionality**	Biometric grant cards stand at more than 75,000 beneficiaries and 1,200 shops, the same figure as a year ago, and the announced citizen wallet has had no follow-up. The biometric grant payment system reached more than 75,000 beneficiaries and 1,200 shops on a platform accredited by three central banks, and the same figure is all the repository holds. No update has been published in the twelve months, and the figure is restated elsewhere under a 2026 heading where it reads as current. 2025-09-17 — a unified Citizen Wallet for subsidy delivery was presented to a rural development council alongside a cryptographic card. Nothing further has appeared in ten months on either. So government-to-person payment in Botswana is one closed-loop card scheme whose numbers have not moved, and a wallet that exists in a presentation.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	**Revenue collection**	Value added tax on non-resident digital services took effect in June 2026 with a collection target of about P450m a year, and electronic invoicing is provided for with no start date. 2026-06-01 — a 14% value added tax on non-resident digital and remote services took effect, with a stated collection target of about P450m a year, the revenue service having set out its intent to tax global digital providers, against a tax system described three months earlier as built for tangible goods. 2026-08-16 — mandatory electronic invoicing is provided for by the 2025 value added tax statute in force from 1 July 2026, with no start date, threshold or scope published. The account is a tax adviser's reading of the Act; no revenue-service notice or timetable is on record. The system that would carry both is unfunded through the estimates: P4.13bn for revenue-service modernisation, covering electronic invoicing, digital taxation and border infrastructure, sits in a development plan with no appropriation trail.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	**B2B and B2G functionality**	A second phase of the retail payment switch and a government cash-deposit system are named in the 2026/27 estimates. 2003 — the National Clearance and Settlement Systems Act empowers the central bank to recognise and regulate clearance and settlement systems, the statutory basis for the interbank rails. 2026-02-26 — the finance ministry named a second phase of the national retail payment switch and a new central-bank digital cash-deposit system for government revenue collection. Neither carries an operator, cost or go-live date on the record, and no business-to-government transaction volume is published.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	**P2P, P2G and P2B functionality**	The switch's second phase is intended to connect banks and mobile-money providers, and the regulatory sandbox opened in March 2026. 2022-02 — the central bank's licensing guidelines define and license the electronic payment categories, person-to-person and person-to-business among them. 2026-02-26 — the second phase of the retail payment switch is intended to connect banks and mobile-money providers. 2026-03-04 — the central bank opened its regulatory sandbox to applicants on a theme of inclusive payments and interoperability. No retail transaction volume or value is published. 2026-09-14 — FNBB said its eWallet will send funds into all three mobile-money platforms; no start date is published. 2026-09-21 - a bank enabled Google Pay on its Visa cards, usable only where merchants hold NFC terminals, which the report says are uneven outside the two largest cities.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	**Population uptake**	A remittance wallet gained a card for cash withdrawal and in-store payment, and a bank and a taxi association launched card acceptance with loans conditioned on the banking history it builds. 2026-08 - two private products arrived in the last three weeks of the window, both routing the unbanked into the formal system rather than onto a public rail. A remittance wallet gained a companion card for cash withdrawal and in-store payment, and a commercial bank and a taxi association launched card acceptance for taxi operators, with access to business loans of up to P60,000 conditioned on the banking history it builds - one bank, one association, no operator count or fee schedule stated. The market beneath them moved both ways at once: mobile-money transaction value rose from P26.5bn in the year to March 2023 to P33.5bn in the year to March 2024 while subscriptions fell 33 per cent, a fall the regulator attributes in part to a clean-up separating registered from active subscribers. One operator holds 78 per cent of mobile-money customers and a second 11 per cent, against mobile-telephony shares of 43, 42 and 15 per cent - the payments market is far more concentrated than the network market under it. 2024 — FinScope put financially excluded adults at 6%, 97,862 people, down from 31% in 2009.	MIXED transaction value rising while subscriptions fell a third

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	**Cross-border functionality**	An instant regional corridor went live inbound from two neighbours in March 2026, and card e-commerce acceptance was extended across nine markets. 2026-03-02 — an instant cross-border corridor went live inbound from South Africa and Zimbabwe, rolled through a commercial bank, where no live regional instant corridor into the country existed. No volume or value figure for the corridor is held. 2026-08-19 — online acceptance of a foreign card scheme opened to participating merchants across nine African markets, settling in local currency, dollars or both, extending a collaboration running since 2024. Nearly 900 participating merchants across the nine markets and about 7 million cards issued in Africa are the two companies' own figures, with no Botswana-specific count. Cross-border rails are ahead of domestic ones here, which is the reverse of the usual order and follows from the absent national switch.	MOVEMENT
Digital Payments and Fintech	**Consumer protection**	A mandatory 60-minute crediting rule for electronic funds transfers took effect on 1 February 2026. 2019 — the central bank's payments oversight policy sets consumer-recourse and fair-disclosure objectives. 2025-12-31 — an enhancement to the clearing and settlement framework introduced a mandatory 60-minute customer crediting rule and an added settlement window, in effect from 1 February 2026. No complaints figure, redress statistic or dispute-resolution route for payment users is held.	MOVEMENT
Registries	**Population register**	The National Registration (Amendment) Act commenced in November 2025, and a biometric card is funded within the wider identity programme. 1986-12-31 — the National Registration Act establishes the register, its contents and the registration requirement. 2026-02-24 — the amending Act of 2025 commenced in November 2025, and funding for an electronic and biometric identity card was folded into the broader digital identity initiative. No registered-population figure, deduplication rate or register-quality measure is published.	MOVEMENT
Registries	**Civil register**	Civil registration runs on a partially automated system across 35 district offices and 17 on-site points. 1969 — the Births and Deaths Registration Act is the founding statute. 2026-08-01 — the registration system is described as partially automated and decentralised, introduced in 2003 and operated through 35 district registration offices and 17 on-site registration points at major health facilities, with the marriage register still manual. 2026-02-24 — online registration of births, deaths and marriages was reported complete, awaiting the government platform's launch. No registration-completeness figure is published.	MOVEMENT
Registries	**Address register**	No national addressing system exists; the addressing component of the land project was never implemented nationally. 2024-06-20 — a case study on rural addressing records that no national addressing system is in place and that the addressing component of the land administration project was never implemented nationally. 2026-03-04 — a four-year modernisation of the land information and geospatial systems was funded in the lands budget, the nearest thing to address infrastructure now moving. The absence was searched on 31 August 2026 and nothing settling it was found.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	**Business register**	The enterprise agency ran nationwide consultations to March-May 2026 and is lobbying for mandatory small-business registration; no database is in build. 2026-04-29 — nationwide consultations ran from March to May 2026 with the enterprise agency lobbying for mandatory registration of small and medium enterprises into a national database. It is proposed only: no instrument, no penalties intended and no database in build. Nothing else on this ledger touches business registration, so the country's record here is a consultation and an intention. The comparison worth making is with the taxi financing product reported under payment uptake, where formalisation is being achieved by a bank offering credit against a transaction history rather than by a register compelling registration.	MOVEMENT a proposal with no instrument behind it
Registries	**Social protection register**	The Single Social Registry reached 98 per cent coverage of beneficiaries in the five main programmes by March 2025, against a 75.8 per cent target. 2022 — a review dates the registry's development to 2016, a pilot in four districts across 2019 and 2020, and six districts uploaded by May 2021. 2025-10-07 — coverage of beneficiaries in the five main poverty-targeted programmes reached 98 per cent by March 2025 against a target of 75.8 per cent. 2025-11-11 — the registry's operationalisation was announced from the podium. No figure for people recorded, as against beneficiaries of existing programmes, is published.	MOVEMENT
Registries	**Electoral register**	P50,000,000 was appropriated for electronic voter registration, with government committing to a reform package built on one-time registration and a verified electronic roll. 2026-08-19 — government committed in Parliament to an electoral-reform package built on one-time voter registration, the national identity card and a verified electronic voters' roll accessible to political parties, after the commission pressed for digital reform in June. P50,000,000 is appropriated within the commission's development budget — the first time the voter register carries a price in any document held. The package has no bill, timetable or procurement on record. 2026-07-06 — an elections management system is built and under extensive testing, replacing platforms developed in the 1990s, with deployment planned for the 2029 general election, and no supplier, cost or acceptance date held. The commission's secretary separately states, as personal opinion, that voters do not want electronic voting machines. The reform rests on the identity card, whose replacement service is failing, reported under digital identity.	MOVEMENT
Registries	**Tax register**	The Tax Administration Act 2026 was assented in June, carrying a registration framework the previous law spread across several statutes. 2026-06-29 — the Act was assented, its 128 sections covering taxpayer registration, assessment and collection. 2026-05-29 — regulations under the VAT Act set the registration and compliance machinery for foreign suppliers of remote services. 2026-02-26 — the finance ministry described a modernisation programme covering real-time taxpayer accounts, automated risk scoring and third-party data integration, and an electronic VAT invoicing solution. No registered-taxpayer count is published.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Registries	**Land register**	The deeds registry remains substantially manual on a workload of 9,000 to 30,000 transactions a year, with no digitisation programme, budget line or date on the record. 2025-10-15 — the deputy registrar described a registry that is substantially manual, carrying 9,000 to 30,000 transactions a year since the 2017-18 land Acts with no added resources. Nothing has moved it since, and no digitisation programme, budget line or date appears. About 70% of the country's land is tribal land, brought into registration by the 2018 Tribal Land Act, so the workload the manual registry carries is the product of a deliberate widening of what must be registered. It is the clearest untouched administrative system in this report: every other registry described here is either being built, tested or funded, and this one is not on anybody's list.	NO CHANGE
Sectoral management information systems	**Health**	DHIS2 is the selected aggregate-data platform, with an intelligence centre, a supplies system and an electronic record all in train. 2026-05-27 — DHIS2 is named as the government's selected aggregate-data platform, alongside VigiFlow, with persistent reporting-quality problems recorded. 2026-01-26 — the health emergency project's core digital component is a logistics management system to track medical supplies in real time from central warehouses to remote health posts. 2026-03-05 — the ministry reported the exchange registries ready for deployment, a national health intelligence centre due before the end of 2025/26, and phase one of the electronic medical record rolling out. No go-live date is published for the intelligence centre or the supplies system. 2026-08-22 — a ten-year partnership was signed with the operator of Abu Dhabi's health information exchange, opening cooperation on digital health transformation, genomics and precision medicine alongside pharmaceutical supply (signing). The country's own exchange registries were reported ready for deployment five months earlier, and nothing states how the two relate.	MOVEMENT on several fronts at once
Sectoral management information systems	**Education**	Phase one of the labour market information system is operational with an education information subsystem; no schools system is held. 2026-03-23 — phase one of the labour market information system went operational with a completed education information subsystem and integrations to the identification system, the company registry and the government SMS gateway, and a second phase funded at P8m. The repository holds no education management information system for basic or secondary schooling — no enrolment system, no teacher register, no school census platform. The absence sits at the level where the sector is largest.	MOVEMENT on the tertiary and labour side only
Sectoral management information systems	**Social protection**	Registry coverage reached 98 per cent while proxy means testing remained unimplemented, on the same report. 2022 — a generic management information system was developed and customised for the public works programme, the fullest account of a programme system the repository holds. 2025-10-07 — the completion report confirms proxy means testing still not implemented, despite the registry's coverage gains. 2025-11-11 — the local government ministry was reported automating key social-protection processes, with proxy means testing announced from the podium a month after the report that found it absent.	MIXED the registry advancing while the targeting tool did not

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	**Justice**	The court records system was reported malfunctioning in January 2026, with a locally built replacement commissioned. 2022-08-05 — the court records management system is the case-file record, holding parties, pleadings, status and orders. 2026-01-21 — the Chief Justice reported the digital records system malfunctioning and a local university engaged to develop a locally managed replacement, against a growing case backlog. 2026-03-16 — the Industrial Court's electronic case management system was developed, with a soft launch planned for the first quarter of 2026/27. No case-disposal or backlog figure is published.	REGRESSED with a replacement under way
Sectoral management information systems	**Tax**	Lekgetho Live is to bring real-time taxpayer accounts, automated risk scoring and third-party data integration to the revenue service. 2026-02-26 — the finance ministry described the modernisation programme as covering real-time taxpayer accounts, automated risk scoring and third-party data integration, alongside an electronic VAT invoicing solution. 2026-06-29 — the Tax Administration Act supplies the statutory framework the system administers. No go-live date, cost or supplier is on the record.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	**Customs**	Pre-lodgment of customs approval became mandatory for commercial road freight from 1 August 2026. 2019-10-22 — the revenue service described migrating from its customs IT system to a national trade platform with an integrated customs management architecture. 2026-07-14 — commercial road freight operators must obtain customs approval before travelling to the border from 1 August 2026. 2026-02-26 — a customs programme covering real-time cargo monitoring and risk profiling, and a track-and-trace system for excisable goods, are scheduled for deployment in 2026/27. No clearance-time or declaration-volume figure is published.	MOVEMENT
Sectoral management information systems	**Land**	A four-year modernisation of the land information and geospatial systems is funded from 2026/27. 2026-02-10 — the modernisation is aimed at outdated systems, fragmented data, weak inter-agency coordination and delays, and runs through a geospatial information centre. 2026-03-04 — Parliament approved a P5.322bn lands and agriculture budget carrying the upgrade, with an electronic deeds registration statute planned. No parcel count, coverage figure or completion date is held.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Other GovTech and e-Gov	**e-government services**	Electronic services rose from 33 to 52 under a Digital Services Act in force with a compliance clock to November 2027, while the payslip portal went offline. 2026-03-18 — the government services platform records electronic services increased from 33 to 52, including teacher registration, appointment scheduling and business facilitation. No usage, transaction or uptake figure is held for either end. The Digital Services Act came into force on 21 November 2025 with a 24-month compliance window running to November 2027, the clock confirmed in February. 2026-07-22 — against that, the government payslip portal is offline with no reopening date after the data-protection regulator's enforcement notice, a privacy notice, an impact assessment, multi-factor authentication and disaster recovery having been added since. It is the only government system on this ledger taken offline by the regulator. Procurement has not moved: the electronic procurement system is still due at the beginning of 2027, and the authority still states it has no real-time data on procurement transactions, against a strategy approved in June 2025. 2026-10-05 - a newspaper reported the transport ministry extending permits and clearing vehicles by hand after a systems outage at the road transport department.	MIXED the services platform grew from 33 to 52 while the regulator took a government portal offline

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	**ICT infrastructure for local government**	The Digital Services Act brings local authorities within its duties; no local-government ICT infrastructure plan of its own is held. 2025-10-17 — the Act applies to all public bodies, local authorities among them, and requires a digital government plan and a centralised public-services platform. 2025-11-25 — the national Tier III data centre was launched as the platform beneath public services delivered through local offices. The repository holds no connectivity, equipment or systems inventory for district and council offices, and no separate local-government ICT budget line.	MOVEMENT by inclusion in a national statute
Digitalisation of sub-national government	**Digitalisation of local government records**	The archives records management system reached its final phase, with a records unit sub-system rolling out to selected ministries. Gaborone City Council, a commercial bank and a local proptech firm launched the PayRates platform for paying property rates online, reported 14 June 2024. The repository holds no take-up figure and no other council on it. 2026-02-24 — the final phase of the national archives records management system is live and its records management unit sub-system is rolling out to selected ministries and departments. 2025-10-17 — sections 17 and 18 of the Digital Services Act require public and private bodies, local authorities included, to keep records in secure electronic form and to digitise existing records to prescribed standards. 2026-02-26 — a national e-procurement system, its strategy approved in June 2025, is to cover the procurement chain across government, local authorities and state enterprises. No council is separately named as having digitised its records.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	**Digitalisation of rural health clinics**	Phase one of the electronic medical record is live at 22 facilities in Ngami, with the remaining districts to follow. 2026-03-05 — phase one of the centralised electronic medical record is rolling out at 22 Ngami facilities, extending to Okavango and the remaining 29 districts. 2025-11-20 — 223 clinics are connected under the village connectivity programme, with legacy systems active but not interfaced, on the minister's answer to Parliament. 2026-01-26 — the health emergency project funds a logistics management system to track supplies to remote health posts. No count of clinics with a working record system is published.	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	**Digitalisation of rural primary schools**	Twelve primary-school ICT laboratories were commissioned in the year to March 2025, taking the national total to 14. 2025-03-01 — the universal access fund commissioned twelve primary-school ICT laboratories in the year to March 2025, bringing the nationwide total to 14, and deployed 219 IT officers. 2026-06-01 — digital centres at Ditladi and Mabele primary schools were launched in November 2025 at P1.59m each. 2026-07-22 — a P1.5m digital centre with 30 laptops, connectivity and a smart board was handed over at Sankoyo primary school. The fund publishes its laboratory count and no denominator: the repository holds no total for the primary school estate the fourteen sit within.	MOVEMENT
Rural digital data capture	**Digitalisation of rural registry offices**	Nine of fifteen hospital registration kiosks still operate, while online registration is reported complete and waiting on the platform. 2026-08-01 — registration runs through 35 district offices and 17 on-site points at major health facilities and clinics, on a system described as partially automated and decentralised. 2026-03-06 — of fifteen hospital kiosks established for on-site birth and death registration, nine remain operational and six have closed, mainly for want of the two officers each was meant to have. 2026-02-24 — online registration of births, deaths and marriages was reported complete, pending the government platform's launch. The closures are staffing, not systems: what constrains rural registration on this record is people.	MIXED online registration complete while kiosks close
Rural digital data capture	**Digitalisation of rural police stations**	Surveillance was extended to six named remote border points, monitorable from police headquarters. 2025-02-17 — administrative data digitalisation reached twelve sectors, with tablets supplied to four agencies including the police service for digital data capture. 2026-06-25 — the surveillance programme expanded to remote border points at Ramotswa, Martins Drift, Maitengwe, Kazungula, Mohembo and Mamuno, monitorable from headquarters, as the commissioner reported cybercrime up 25 per cent on the year under review. What the repository does not hold is any account of case or record systems inside rural stations: the movement on record is cameras, not files.	MOVEMENT on surveillance rather than station systems

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	**Use of AI in government administration**	The Chief Justice stated that the judiciary had resolved to train judges in artificial intelligence and emerging technologies; no programme, budget or date is on record. 2026-01-22 — the Chief Justice stated that the judiciary had resolved to train judges in artificial intelligence and emerging technologies, against cases involving artificial intelligence and digital evidence. A commitment is stated and no programme, budget, date or filing rollout is on record. It is the only state-side artificial-intelligence commitment the repository holds for the country, and it is a training resolution rather than a deployment. No government system on this ledger uses artificial intelligence, and no national policy, strategy or regulatory instrument is held at any date.	MOVEMENT
AI	**Use of AI in sectoral management information systems**	Sectoral pilots are named in the policy process and a real-time health data platform is due; nothing is in production. 2025-01 — the readiness assessment is the repository's most authoritative statement on whether AI governance exists at all. 2025-08-13 — pilots were named in agriculture, remote-area health diagnostics and machine-learning-assisted digitisation of licensing and social welfare. 2026-03-05 — a national health intelligence centre was announced as a real-time platform running from community health workers to tertiary hospitals. No sectoral system is described as using AI in production, and no procurement for one is held. 2026-09-15 - a US clinical decision-support platform was announced for extension to Botswana through the Botswana-UPenn Partnership, with no timetable, site count or cost.	MOVEMENT at pilot and announcement stage
AI	**Development of national / regional AI systems**	Adoption sits at 0 to 0.40 chatbot visits per internet user a month on a 0 to 2.6 scale, among the lowest measured. 2025-12-12 — a readiness framing puts artificial-intelligence adoption at 0 to 0.40 chatbot visits per internet user a month on a scale to 2.6, among the lowest adopters, in a band covering about 45% of Africa. It is a reference study, cited and not absorbed, and the source is paywalled after two paragraphs. Nothing on this ledger records a model, dataset, laboratory or application built in the country. The compute that would host one is being built for export rather than for domestic research: the solar campus reported under data storage is targeted at hyperscale and artificial-intelligence workloads and remains a memorandum. An offer of cooperation arrived from outside, reported under geopolitics, and no national response is on file.	NO CHANGE
AI	**Control of AI abuse**	The readiness assessment was validated and a minister warned publicly about harm to children; no control framework exists. 2025-11-03 — the minister told the UNESCO General Conference that Botswana had validated the readiness assessment methodology, calling it a key milestone toward a governance and regulatory framework. 2026-07-22 — the communications minister warned that chatbots had given harmful advice to children and called for stronger governance and developer accountability. No AI-specific Act, regulation, code of practice or complaints route is held. The absence was searched on 31 August 2026.	MOVEMENT on diagnosis rather than control

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
ICT Industry	**National capacity in DT-related production**	The state wholesale operator's revenue fell to P376m from P485m and the incumbent's profit fell 45% to P146.2m, both against rising service volumes. 2026-08-13 — the state wholesale operator's first integrated report puts revenue for the year ended 31 March 2025 at P376m against P485m the year before, alongside 71% national broadband penetration, 206 villages connected to the backbone, 17,586 homes covered with fibre to the home, 1,272 public wireless premises and a fifth consecutive year of profitability without government subvention. It manages access to three international submarine systems and escalated two material risks to its board: disruption from low-earth-orbit satellite operators, and liquidity pressure from declining wholesale revenues. The financial statements are audited; the non-financial disclosures are not. 2026-07-06 — the listed incumbent's profit before tax fell 45% to P146.2m on revenue of P1.47bn, down 1.6%, against a prior year in which data and broadband demand pushed revenue up. Two state-linked operators carrying the national network, both with falling returns, is the industrial position underneath every connectivity figure in this report.	REGRESSED
Innovation ecosystem	**Technology hubs**	UniPod Botswana opened with ten specialised laboratories and six start-ups at commercial acceleration stage. 2023 — an independent policy review names the digital and innovation hub, the technology research institute and the agricultural research institute among the national system's hub institutions. 2026-02-26 — the higher education minister toured UniPod Botswana, described as the first of its kind in the country, with ten specialised laboratories and six start-ups at commercial acceleration stage. 2026-07-27 — South Africa's technology innovation agency and the Botswana Digital and Innovation Hub agreed a five-year joint programme and fund covering co-funding, commercialisation and cross-border innovation development. No occupancy, funding or graduation figure is published for any hub.	MOVEMENT
Innovation ecosystem	**Tech startup ecosystem**	The innovation system ranked 87th of 139 in the 2025 Global Innovation Index, with early-stage finance diagnosed as nascent. 2021-12 — a technical note diagnoses the early-stage finance market as nascent. 2026-02-04 — the national innovation network met for the first time in January 2026, with participants naming fragmented pathways, siloed programmes and disjointed funding as the barriers. 2026-07-29 — a Bill to create a national research and innovation council was presented to Parliament, reporting the innovation system ranked 87th of 139 in the 2025 index with research and development intensity below 0.5 per cent of output. No count of active start-ups, funding rounds or exits is published. The sector's first census, published in 2026, counts more than 100 startups operating across fintech, e-commerce, agritech, artificial intelligence, mobility, edtech and healthtech, which together raised less than US$10 million between 2019 and 2025. It puts a figure on what the 2021 diagnostic could only call nascent; both are the publisher's own compilation rather than a deal database.	MOVEMENT against a market still described as nascent

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	**Digital literacy (civil service)**	Regulators from four countries began geographic-information and data-management training in Botswana under a continental broadband mapping project. 2026-06-01 — subregional geographic-information and data-management training commenced in Botswana with the regulator and the regional association, attended by regulators from Botswana, Malawi, Zambia and Zimbabwe under a continental broadband maps project. Nothing preceded it and the publisher is a wire service flagged in the source. It is the only public-sector capability activity on this ledger. Its subject is mapping, which is also the country's clearest data gap: no broadband map has been published, reported under administrative statistics, and the fibre network's own length rests on a ministerial statement with no register behind it.	MOVEMENT
Literacy	**Digital literacy (general population)**	The regulator ran information and cyber-awareness sessions at four schools in January 2026; no national coverage figure exists. 2026-01-22 — the regulator ran information and communications technology and cyber-awareness sessions at four schools, on a wire source flagged at ingest. No baseline preceded it and no national coverage figure is published. No dated national digital-literacy or digital-skills rate is held for the country at any date. So four schools is the entire measured literacy activity of the window, against a services platform carrying 52 electronic services and a tax regime that now reaches online purchases.	MOVEMENT
Training and skills	**DT-related training in secondary education**	A P654.4m schools coding and robotics contract was awarded by direct procurement, its financial evaluation received, adjudicated and approved the same day. 2026-06-25 — a contract for a schools electronic-learning, coding and robotics programme was awarded by direct procurement at P654.4m, with the financial evaluation received, adjudicated and approved on the same day and the decision published on 8 July. An appeal court cleared the procurement route about six months earlier; that judgment is not held, and this rests on a paywalled opening paragraph. The vote behind it spent nothing in the preceding year: basic education computerisation was appropriated at P270,000,000, revised to P38,819,833 and executed at zero. So the largest single digital award in this report was made by direct procurement in one day, from a budget line with no track record of spending, for a programme with no published curriculum, school count or timetable.	MOVEMENT
Training and skills	**DT-related university facilities and qualifications**	The university launched the country's first virtual-reality programme, giving remote access to its laboratories. 2026-04-16 — the country's first local virtual-reality programme launched with a partner innovation hub, giving remote access to university laboratories. Nothing of the kind existed before it and no user numbers, cost or funder is on record. Remote laboratory access is the right instrument for a country whose higher-education computerisation vote is P16,000,000 — the smallest clean-scope digital line in the estimates and the only one fully spent. No degree programme, department or graduate count in a digital discipline appears anywhere on this ledger.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Training and skills	**Graduates entering DT ecosystem**	A labour market information system is near completion, with only facilitation and training remaining; no go-live date, cost or supplier is held. 2026-06-08 — the permanent secretary told a parliamentary committee that only facilitation and training remain before the labour market information system goes live, on a paywalled opening paragraph, with no go-live date, cost or supplier held. No baseline preceded it. Until it runs, the country has no instrument that could answer this indicator: no graduate count, no placement rate and no sector employment figure appears on this ledger, against a roadmap whose headline commitment is 100,000 technology jobs within five years.	MOVEMENT
Research institutions	**Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy**	The national research agenda spent P9.5m across the same 45 projects in the year, five completed and none added. 2026-03-25 — P9.5m was spent across 45 projects, five completed and no new projects added, on an agenda Cabinet approved in July 2025 with eight focus areas and 22 thematic priorities. The 45 were approved in 2024 and carried forward, so the project count is unchanged for a second year. A research agenda that adds nothing in a year is not a pipeline. Nothing on this ledger records a think tank, a policy institute or a university department contributing to digital policy, and the roadmap reported under strategy names no research input.	NO CHANGE

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	**Citizen feedback portals**	Botswana Speaks carries citizen messages to members of Parliament by web and phone, free of charge. 2026-01 — the platform lets citizens communicate with their members of Parliament on constituency and national issues, including Bills, free and through web and mobile. 2025-08-21 — the forensic audit public engagement platform, launched in August 2025, published its contact channels for public submissions. 2026-02-10 — 52 public services are fully available online with a further 179 in integration testing. No submission or response figure is published for either platform.	MOVEMENT
Access to services	**Citizen participation in policy**	The pre-budget consultation and constitutional court consultations both ran in the window, on top of the statutory local channel. 2012 — the Local Government Act establishes councils and, at Part XII, the district, urban, village and ward development committees that carry citizen participation into local planning. 2026-01-27 — the pre-budget consultation gathered stakeholders in Gaborone ahead of the 2026/27 budget. 2026-01-29 — trade unions and faith bodies were consulted on the proposed constitutional court, framed as giving vulnerable citizens a route to challenge unfair decisions. No participation figure, and no record of how a submission changed a decision, is held.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	**Gender equity**	A four-pillar gender-responsive violence prevention programme launched in June 2026, with one-stop centres being established. 2026-03-24 — one-stop service centres are being established to bring medical, legal, counselling and psychosocial support for survivors of gender-based violence under one roof, addressing the gap between reporting and support. 2026-06-10 — a joint government and United Nations gender-responsive prevention and response programme was launched on a four-pillar framework. The Department of Gender Affairs is secretariat to the National Gender Commission. No prevalence, caseload or centre-count figure is published.	MOVEMENT
Access to services	**Inclusion of persons with disabilities**	Core Parts of the Persons With Disability Act were commenced and disability defined by regulation in December 2025. 2025-12-04 — two statutory instruments were gazetted, one defining who qualifies as a person with a disability and one commencing specified Parts of the Act. The repository holds nothing on accessibility of digital public services, assistive technology provision, or whether the commenced Parts carry duties on the systems this report covers. The instrument is in force and its reach into digital service delivery is not on the record.	MOVEMENT
Access to services	**Inclusion of refugees and IDPs**	The Refugees (Recognition and Management) Act commenced on 1 November 2025. 2026-03-01 — the minister confirmed commencing the Act on 1 November 2025, its provisions aligned to protection of refugees' family members. 2026-06-22 — 64 long-term refugees were granted citizenship on World Refugee Day, meeting a Global Refugee Forum commitment. 2026-04-03 — flooding in the Palapye sub-district between 15 and 19 March 2026 displaced people and cut access to services. No framework for internally displaced people is held, and no figure for registered refugees is published.	MOVEMENT
Digital divides	**Bridging of digital divides**	The universal fund handed over two school digital centres at P1.45m and P1.5m per site, while the single community wireless site has had no successor in fourteen months. 2026-10-12 — the communications minister said the universal fund's broadband expansion project has deployed 12 mobile broadband and voice sites along the Trans-Kalahari Highway, a P34.5 million investment. A two-day multistakeholder workshop in Gaborone mapped the creative industries to shape a more inclusive digital future (workshop). 2026-07-22 — two school digital centres were handed over in one district at P1.45m and P1.5m per site, thirty machines each, the second framed as addressing the rural divide. The fund is a 1% levy on mobile service providers, no programme total or school target is published, and the repository carried nothing on its school programme before January 2026. Against that, the community wireless site launched in June 2025 with tariffs of P2 to P10 and a free 45-minute daily window remains the only one, with no second site recorded in fourteen months. Two laboratories and one hotspot is the whole of the published inclusion delivery, against an unresolved dispute about what the national penetration rate even is, reported under internet usage.	MOVEMENT

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	**National strategy for development of statistics**	A second statistics development strategy for 2026 to 2030 was launched in August 2026, and a substantive statistician general took post. 2026-08-12 — the second statistics development strategy for 2026 to 2030 launched, aligned to the twelfth national development plan, jointly with the university. No budget, delivery milestones or indicator set is published with it. 2025-10 — a substantive statistician general was appointed, succeeding an acting holder, with data quality described by a named analyst as worryingly uneven. Both are institutional repairs rather than outputs, and the unevenness the analyst names is visible throughout this report: two irreconcilable internet penetration figures, a fibre length with no register behind it, and a grant-payment figure restated a year later as if current.	MOVEMENT
National statistics	**Censuses and surveys**	Preliminary 2024/25 household survey results put unemployment at 21.0 per cent, against 17.6 per cent in 2015/16. 2026-03-01 — preliminary labour-force results from the 2024/25 multi-topic household survey put unemployment for people aged 15 and over at 21.0 per cent, against 17.6 per cent in 2015/16, with a full analytical report to follow. 2026-07-08 — the first tourism satellite account was launched alongside the 2025 inbound visitor survey. 2010-12-01 — the Statistics Act carries the ten-yearly census mandate. No date for the next population and housing census is on the record.	MOVEMENT
National statistics	**Statistics from administrative data**	Subregional broadband mapping training is under way with three neighbours; no Botswana broadband map has been published. 2026-06-01 — geographic-information and data-management training is under way in Botswana with Malawi, Zambia and Zimbabwe under a continental broadband maps project, and no Botswana broadband map has been published. The publisher is a wire service, flagged in the source frontmatter. A published coverage map would settle several of the disputes in this report at once: where the fibre network actually runs, which villages the connectivity project has reached, and what the difference is between the two penetration figures in circulation. The training is the first step toward one and no output date is stated. 2026-09-02 — a dated absence: no gambling participation statistics are held as the country moves to lower the legal betting age, while an investigation reports unregistered betting influencers drawing 4,000 to 15,000 responses to a single betting slip. The activity is documented and the population is not counted.	MOVEMENT
Open data	**Use of open data**	A tourism statistics dashboard went live in April 2026, the clearest instance of reuse; the open data policy remains unadopted. 2025-10-17 — Part V of the Digital Services Act establishes the open data framework, requiring machine-readable publication and enterprise data inventories. 2026-04-15 — a tourism statistics dashboard was launched with Japanese agency support, to track industry growth. 2026-03-14 — terms of reference were issued for a second phase of hackathons and a forum, tied to the policy's anticipated adoption. No national open data portal exists, and no dataset count or licence is published.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Use of satellite data	**Agricultural use of satellite data**	The national hyperspectral satellite is in orbit with commercialisation still stated as the next phase, and no product, customer or revenue is held. The satellite launched in March 2025 with an in-country ground station, hyperspectral, with data commercialisation stated as the next phase; 2026-03-18 — commercialisation is still stated as the next phase, with no product, customer or revenue held. Hyperspectral imagery is the instrument for crop, rangeland and mineral analysis, and no agricultural, environmental or land-management use of it appears anywhere on this ledger — including in the deeds registry reported under land, which remains substantially manual. A satellite in orbit for eighteen months with no named user is the clearest instance in this report of capability arriving ahead of any application for it.	NO CHANGE
Use of satellite data	**Meteorological use of satellite data**	A satellite ground receiving and processing system was donated to the meteorological service; the applications on record are academic. 2023-12-12 — China donated a meteorological satellite ground receiving and processing system to the Department of Meteorological Services at COP28. 2026-03-20 — a study regionalised drought using long-term satellite rainfall data and recommended building climate indices into national early-warning systems. 2026-03-25 — a second study linked satellite-derived drought indices to crop-yield variability for agricultural monitoring. Both studies recommend operational use; the repository holds no early-warning system that has adopted either.	MOVEMENT in research rather than operations

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	**USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments**	Botswana signed the Artemis Accords as the 68th signatory in June 2026, about fifteen months after its satellite launch. 2026-06-25 — the accords were signed at the American space agency's headquarters, making the country the 68th signatory, about fifteen months after the national satellite launch. It is a wire account and the signed instrument is not held. It is the only United States engagement on this ledger and it concerns space rather than digital infrastructure. No American technology vendor, cloud provider or financing instrument appears in the record for the country at any date, which is unusual for a middle-income economy with a certified data centre and a listed incumbent operator.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
China activities	**Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments**	China's ambassador publicly offered artificial-intelligence cooperation in smart mining, digital government and talent training; a vendor academy runs at five universities. 2026-08-25 — the ambassador publicly offered cooperation on artificial intelligence in smart mining, digital government and talent training, pitching it as a lever for economic diversification and pointing to a July 2026 pledge of 5,000 training places for developing countries and application cooperation centres for bodies including the African Union. It is an offer rather than an instrument: no Botswanan response, memorandum or programme is on file. The delivered engagement is educational. A vendor academy operates with five tertiary institutions, certifying in cloud, networking, data management and cybersecurity, with a competition run across five named universities in 2025-26. The source reads as vendor-supplied copy and no student numbers or funding are held. An offer of artificial-intelligence cooperation lands in a country with no artificial-intelligence policy and adoption among the lowest measured, reported above. 2026-08-24 — the case was made in the domestic press before it was made in an instrument: China's ambassador published a signed article setting out a case for deepening bilateral digital and artificial-intelligence cooperation. No Botswanan response is on file.	MOVEMENT
EU activities	**EU MoUs, engagements and commitments**	A EUR 1,500,000 digital transformation facility committed in 2022 still shows nothing disbursed. A cooperation facility for digital transformation was committed in 2022 with an activity period running to 2030, at EUR 1,500,000, with nothing disbursed at the record's access date. It is a grant record only and no delivery milestone on the Botswana side is held. Four years of a nine-year facility with no disbursement is the position. The minister has named three European states assisting on legal-framework alignment, and no instrument, value or timeframe for that assistance is stated anywhere on this ledger — so the European contribution to the country's digital statutes is visible in outcomes and invisible in documents. The European programme is the one running instrument rather than an offer: support to digital transformation delivered through three European agencies, working on interoperability, open data and legal-framework alignment. No budget, milestone or end date is published.	NO CHANGE
Gulf/UAE activities	**Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments**	A ten-year health partnership was signed in August 2026 with the operator of Abu Dhabi's health information exchange — the first Gulf instrument on the repository with a named counterparty and a term. Heads of agreement with a Gulf counterparty were negotiated in March 2025 with site and technical planning progressed by September 2025; 2026-08-03 — the counterparty is not named in the operator's quarterly account. It is the only Gulf instrument the repository holds for the country at any date, and the silence is the finding: the data centre it concerned is now commissioned and reporting revenue, reported under storage, with no statement of whether the agreement survived into the operating phase. 2026-08-22 — the health ministry signed a ten-year strategic partnership with the operator of Abu Dhabi's health information exchange, for pharmaceutical and medical supply and opening cooperation on digital health transformation, genomics, precision medicine, health-sector investment and capacity development (signing, counterparty). No sum, delivery milestone or data-custody arrangement is published — and a health-information-exchange operator entering a country building its own exchange is the part the record does not address.	MOVEMENT

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
India activities	**India MoUs, engagements and commitments**	The first presidential visit from India took place in November 2025, with cooperation agreed across digital technology among other fields. 2025-11-12 — India's President visited Botswana for the first time, with cooperation agreed across trade, energy, health, education, defence and digital technology, and a pharmacopoeia agreement signed. 2025-12-17 — the minerals and energy ministry signed a memorandum with India's KP Group envisaging about $4bn of renewable energy and transmission infrastructure. 2026-04-01 — India's official country brief is the fullest statement of the relationship the repository holds. No instrument from the visit is published, and the memorandum carries no build on the record.	MOVEMENT
Digital sovereignty	**Digital sovereignty**		NO EVIDENCE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
AI legislation or regulations	an AI Act, or regulations made under an existing statute, with a gazette reference	2026-08-31
National IPv6 transition plan	a regulator or ministry IPv6 transition plan with a target date, or a published IPv6 adoption percentage for Botswana	not yet probed
Audited outturn for digital budget lines	the Auditor General's report on the accounts of the Government of Botswana for FY2024/25 or FY2025/26	not yet probed
National Cybersecurity Strategy	the strategy document itself, or a gazette notice or ministerial statement giving its date of adoption and version	not yet probed
National address register	a national addressing standard or register with a coverage figure, or a ministerial statement that none is planned	2026-08-31
National digital literacy measure	a dated statistics-office or regulator household ICT survey reporting a digital-literacy or digital-skills rate	not yet probed
Official internet penetration figure	the regulator's annual report, or a statistics-office household ICT access survey	2026-08-31
Gambling participation statistics	An official participation series, an age breakdown or any independent research establishing who is betting, at what age and with whose money. None is held as the legal betting age is being lowered.	not yet probed
Universal Access and Service Fund receipts and disbursements	the fund's audited annual accounts or BOCRA annual-report figures for levy receipts, surplus transfers and disbursements would settle it; probed 2026-09-25, the framework states the sources but no held document gives their scale	2026-09-25
Financing source of recurrent digital lines	the recurrent estimates print no financing column; a statement of whether any recurrent digital spending is externally financed would settle it; probed 2026-09-25, none held	2026-09-25
State control of identity-system source code and support contracts	the identity system's support contracts, or a ministry statement on source-code ownership and exit terms, would settle it; probed 2026-09-25, the latest held account is the 2018 ID4D diagnostic	2026-09-25
Data terms of the ADHDS health partnership	publication of the agreement's data-residency, portability and exit clauses would settle it; probed 2026-09-25, neither party's announcement states them	2026-09-25
Where the state's AI compute and models are hosted	a national AI policy or strategy addressing hosting, compute and model ownership would settle it; probed 2026-09-25, the policy was still in drafting	2026-09-25

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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